

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 5
 ♥ K Q 8 6 3
 ♦ K 6 2
 ♣ A 3

♠ A J 2

♥ A 10 5

♦ A J 7

♣ J 9 7 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 8 7 4

♥ J 9

♦ 8 5 4 3

♣ K Q 10

♠ K 6 3

♥ 7 4 2

♦ Q 10 9

♣ 8 5 4 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	1NT		
All Pass			
1NT by North			

With no reason to think you could improve the contract you just pass.

The contract would be 1NT played by South.

North plays 1NT. East leads the ♥J and West plays the ♥8. Do you hold up? If so, how many times?

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = 4

It probably makes no difference whether you hold up or not since West surely has most of the high cards. However, holding up once is a good idea because East may have a singleton ♥ and have to switch to something which helps you. East holds the first trick and plays another ♥, which you win.

You must find 4 winners. The bad news is that you must finesse both the ♦K and the ♠Q. The good news is that with West opening the bidding there is a good chance he has both of them. So, how will you manage those two finesses?

There is only one way to do it. Enter dummy with the only entry, the ♠K. Take the ♦ finesse first - play the ♦Q and unblock your ♦J when West plays low. (you could play the ♦10/♦7 combination first).

Finesse the ♦ again. If West ducks a second time you must now take the ♠ finesse while you are still in dummy. If West covers the second ♦ you win with your ♦A, return to dummy with the ♦9, and then finesse the ♠.

Having used dummy's lone entry to get there in the first place you have to make sure you take the finesse that permits you to either remain in dummy, or to return if West plays his King.

And you have to be careful to unblock so you don't inadvertently lose your place in dummy too soon.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 6
♥ Q J 10 9 8
♦ 8 6 3
♣ K 2

♠ A 7 5 3

♥ K 6

♦ Q J 5 2

♣ 10 9 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 9 8 2

♥ 5 3 2

♦ A 9

♣ 8 7 6 4

♠ K 4

♥ A 7 4

♦ K 10 7 4

♣ A Q J 5

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by South

another one from the ♣ suit as well. If you assume the ♣ finesse will fail, (and you have probably noticed that most finesses **DO** fail on these pages), that means you will lose the lead twice.

So what do you do about that ♥Q? Do you win or hold up?

You hold up, of course, to cut defensive communications when West has 5 ♥s and East has 3. West will probably play another ♥ to dummy's ♥K.

If both the ♦A and ♣K are in West's hand then you won't make this contract. He will easily establish his ♥s and have an entry to get in and cash them. If the ♦A is with West and the ♣K is with East then it doesn't matter in which order you play the suits since you will not lose the lead in ♣s. But if the ♣K is with West and the ♦A is with East then it is vital that you play ♣s first.

If you play on ♦s first, East will win the ♦A and play his last ♥, forcing out your ♥A. When West wins his ♣K he will cash 2 more ♥s.

But, if you finesse in ♣s first, West can win and establish the ♥ suit. But, when East wins the ♦A, he will have no ♥ to return.

With no 4-card Major suit you respond 2♦ to partner's Stayman bid. Partner now bids 2NT.

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With 17 points you naturally accept partner's invitation and bid 3NT.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♥Q.

West's ♥Q lead presents you with an immediate decision (or two) to make.

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 5

You need 4 additional winners and can only establish 3 of them in ♦s. So you will have to manufacture another one from the ♣ suit as well. If you assume the ♣ finesse will fail, (and you have probably noticed that most finesses **DO** fail on these pages), that means you will lose the lead twice.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 6 2
♥ Q 6 5
♦ 10 9 3
♣ J 7 5 4

♠ J 5

♥ A 9 7 3

♦ K 6 4

♣ A K 6 2



♠ 10 9 8 4

♥ 10 4

♦ 8 7 5 2

♣ Q 10 3

♠ A K 7 3

♥ K J 8 2

♦ A Q J

♣ 9 8

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

6♥ by North

and the points are right. But with two 4-card Majors you should use Stayman, so you bid 2♣. Partner bids 2♥. Now what do say next?

You might just go ahead and bid 6♥. Partner probably has at least one Ace for his 1NT opening. The other choice is a Blackwood 4NT, and while you don't like to use Blackwood when you have a worthless doubleton, this bid will at least keep you out of slam if partner has ZERO Aces. You bid 4NT and partner replies 5♥. Next?

He has two Aces so you bid 6♥ because you know there aren't enough points for seven.

The contract would be 6♥ played by South.

North plays 6♥. East leads the ♠10.

You toy with the idea of letting this ride to your ♠J, then you put away your childish toys and play the ♠A from dummy.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 3

The two ♣ losers can be ruffed in dummy. A successful ♥ finesse could save you a loser in trumps. So, should you take the ♥ finesse now?

No, because if you play ♥A, then the ♥ finesse **LOSES**, West might play a third ♥ and stop you from your two ruffs in dummy. A much better plan is to play the ♥K, then ♥A, and if the ♥Q drops, well and good. This time she doesn't, but both West and East follow to both trump leads. Play the ♣ A K, the ♠K, and the ♦ A K Q.

If somebody ruffs any of these it will be with the master trump and you won't care. But if they don't ruff yet, you just start cross-ruffing ♣s and ♠s and let them ruff in whenever they like.

Missing 5 trumps to the Queen the correct play to avoid a loser is to finesse.

But that is only correct as far as that suit is concerned. When you look at the entire hand you may find that by taking your two high trumps and leaving the master Queen out you can make all four of your small ones

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